



RIPOSTE LABORATORIES INC.

Daily Bread is baked quarterly in Kelowna,  
BC. Free where you found it. Pay what you  
can where you can't.



ISSN PENDING  
#1 • SUMMER 2026

*see you at the thaw X*

---

PRINTED ON UNCEDED SYILX OKANAGAN TERRITORY IN A RUN OF 500. SET  
IN IBM PLEX MONO AND UNIFRAKTURMAGUNTIA. ERRORS ARE OURS;  
CORRECTIONS ARE YOURS; THE LEFTOVER INK WENT INTO THE STICKERS.  
• PARRY. RIPOSTE.



FREE / PWYC

# Daily Bread

A QUEER MAGAZINE FOR THE  
OKANAGAN

You found the first issue of a  
queer magazine in a city that  
keeps telling us it doesn't  
have one. Kelowna has queer  
history, queer kids, queer  
elders, queer bakers and  
bureaucrats; what it hasn't had  
is paper that says so out loud.

ISSUE №1 • SUMMER 2026

KELOWNA'S COLLAPSE • 48 PP •

PRINT RUN 500

BATCH №1 • FRESH

READ THE ISSUE ↓



APPENDIX A3 · CUT ON A MACHINE

## Stickers · crosshairs

Crosshairs 10 mm in from three corners of the trim: register the cutter on them, then cut with the cut file.



Cut from a copy printed at 100 % (Printer PDF, or Web PDF at actual size), not the booklet, which prints smaller. A Cricut uses the sticker page itself: the studio's Stickers for a cutter PNG, through Design Space.



Sec.00

// editor's letter

## OUR DAILY DREAD

**S** I. You found the first issue of a queer magazine in a city that keeps telling us it doesn't have one. Kelowna has queer history, queer kids, queer elders, queer bakers and bureaucrats; what it hasn't had is paper that says so out loud.

This issue is about collapse: the orchards, the venues, the rent math, the bridge traffic. Not because we're doomers, but because things fall apart here on schedule, and naming the schedule is the first act of repair.

Rip out the poster. Colour the cartoon. Mail us your fury and your recipes. This thing only works if you get crumbs on it.

— the editors ✕

MASTHEAD / #1 · SUMMER DB-  
2026 000

|              |                |
|--------------|----------------|
| EDITOR       | your name here |
| ART + COMICS | open call      |
| YOUNG VOICES | three writers, |
| DESK         | 17-24          |
| PRINTED      | unceded syilx  |
| ON           | territory      |

Daily Bread is published on the unceded, ancestral territory of the syilx Okanagan people. We pay rent to a landlord and respect to a Nation, and we know only one of those is owed.



FUNDED BY RIPOSTE  
LABORATORIES INC.



# CONTENTS.

Twelve contributors made #1: writers aged 17-74, two photographers, one cartoonist, one very patient proofreader.

Every byline is local. Every fee got paid before the printer did.

| MANIFEST / 48 PP |                                      |               | DB-TOC |                                       |                   |
|------------------|--------------------------------------|---------------|--------|---------------------------------------|-------------------|
| 01               | Our Daily Dread – editor's letter    | HOU<br>SE     | 04     | Before the Bridge – a rude history    | HIS<br>TOR<br>Y   |
| 08               | Vacancy – photo essay, Bernard Ave   | PH<br>OT<br>O | 11     | Young Voices – three field reports    | OPI<br>NIO<br>N   |
| 14               | Crumbs – ep.1, a golem seeks housing | CO<br>MI<br>C | 16     | Forty Years of Nerve – Miss Demeanour | INTE<br>RVIE<br>W |
| 19               | Lake Effect / Harvest – poems        | LI<br>T       | 20     | The Wall – rip-out centrefold         | AR<br>T           |
| 23               | Colour Your Own Collapse             | SATI<br>RE    | 24     | Peel Me – sticker sheet               | STICKE<br>RS      |
| 25               | The Waitlist – healthcare feature    | ISS<br>UES    | 28     | The Lake Takes – fiction pt.1         | LI<br>T           |
| 30               | From the Lab – funder disclosure     | RIPO<br>STE   | 32     | Ask a Local Gay / Reviews / Calendar  | SER<br>VIC<br>E   |
| 36               | The Bite Back – restaurant critique  | FO<br>OD      | 37     | Rotation – what we're listening to    | MU<br>SI<br>C     |
| 38               | The Rewind + Movies in the Park      | FI<br>LM      | 40     | Directory + Crumbs Mail               | AI<br>D           |
| 44               | Who Made This – staff, assembled     | COLO<br>PHON  |        |                                       |                   |

## APPENDIX A2 · CUT ON A MACHINE

### Stickers · Brother ScanNCut

Brother ScanNCut: no marks needed. Put the page on the mat, Scan, Direct Cut: the outlines are the cut lines.



Cut from a copy printed at 100 % (Printer PDF, or Web PDF at actual size), not the booklet, which prints smaller. A Cricut uses the sticker page itself: the studio's Stickers for a cutter PNG, through Design Space.

## Stickers · Silhouette

Silhouette Studio: page 148 × 210 mm, Registration Marks on, Type 1, length 20 mm, thickness 0.5 mm, inset 10 mm. Open the cut file, then Send.



Cut from a copy printed at 100 % (Printer PDF, or Web PDF at actual size), not the booklet, which prints smaller. A Cricut uses the sticker page itself: the studio's Stickers for a cutter PNG, through Design Space.

## A RUDE HISTORY

The valley sold itself twice: first as Eden, then as equity. Fruit ranchers went broke so often the packinghouses printed their own scrip; when fruit died, the pitch became retirement sun; when the retirees priced out the pickers, the pitch became lakeside lofts. Each act ended the same way, with the people who did the work living further from the water.

The queer history is braided through all of it: dance halls with unofficial nights, friendship networks that doubled as housing lists, a scene that survived by being useful and quiet until it didn't have to be.

*"quiet until it didn't have to be"  
— put on a shirt*

## LEDGER / WHAT COLLAPSED WHEN

| ENTRY |                                                | STATUS            |
|-------|------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| 1913  | fruit prices crater; scrip economy begins      | B<br>US<br>T      |
| 1930s | packinghouse layoffs, valley-wide              | B<br>US<br>T      |
| 1958  | bridge opens; ferry workers obsolete overnight | P<br>IV<br>O<br>T |
| 1973  | ALR freezes orchard speculation (briefly)      | P<br>ARR<br>Y     |
| 1980s | sawmill era ends; wine era begins              | PI<br>VO<br>T     |
| 2003  | firestorm; 239 homes, 30k evacuated            | B<br>UR<br>N      |
| 2017  | flood year; the lake takes the boardwalk       | F<br>LOO<br>D     |
| 2021  |                                                |                   |

|                                              |                 |
|----------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| heat dome; hottest place<br>in Canada, again | BU<br>RN        |
| 2024 last dedicated<br>queer venue closes    | BU<br>ST        |
| 2026 this magazine.<br>your move, city.      | RIP<br>QST<br>E |

**METHOD** — COMPILED FROM CITY ARCHIVES, NEWSPAPER MORGUES, AND ELDERS WHO WERE THERE. CORRECTIONS WELCOME AND EXPECTED.



FIG. 1 — THE FLOATING BRIDGE, 1958. TRAFFIC ARRIVED; THE FERRY DIED THE SAME DAY.

Every boom since has made the same promise, and every bust has been treated as a surprise. Fruit prices collapsed. Sawmills closed. The 2003 firestorm ate 239 homes while the city watched from the beach.

## Sec. 24

// peel me · sticker sheet · the leftover ink went here

# PEEL ME.

The leftover ink went here. Print the page, cut along the dashes, and put the valley on your water bottle. Twelve stickers; no two collapses alike.

PRINT THIS SHEET

OR PRESS CTRL / ⌘ + P · CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINES



RISO-PRINTED ON THE OFFCUTS. IF A COLOUR'S OFF, THAT'S THE POINT.



LABORATORIES INC.

## FROM THE LAB

Full disclosure, printed large: this magazine is funded by Riposte Laboratories, a Kelowna outfit that counter-attacks waste with recycled-plastic injection molding and reclaimed-cell modular power. We share what we're building here, in the same pages, at the same volume as everyone else.

The deal, in writing: the Lab pays the printer and gets two pages. The editors answer to readers, not the funder. If that ever changes, the colouring page will let you know.

FUNDER DISCLOSURE · SIGNED

*parry. riposte. recycle.*

### THIS QUARTER / STATUS BOARD

Q3 · 2026

REV. A

Plastic Works — molds  
v2, park benches from #5  
tubs

L

IV

E

Project HEX —  
reclaimed-cell grading  
rig

WI

P

Esh — shop assistant,  
currently a whiteboard

DRA

WIN

G

Daily Bread №2 — theme  
vote

OPE

N

First Friday open  
doors — bring clean  
plastics

RECU

RRIN

G

### WHY FUND A MAGAZINE?

Because a lab that fixes  
material waste in a town  
losing its cultural material  
would be doing half a job.  
Paper is infrastructure. So  
are drag nights. Line item  
approved.

TOUR THE SHOP: OPEN DOORS FIRST  
FRIDAYS · BRING CLEAN #2 + #5  
PLASTICS.

This issue asks the impolite  
question: what if collapse  
isn't the exception here — what  
if it's the business model? The  
ledger has the receipts.

ARCHIVAL PHOTO — ORCHARD  
CREWS, 1910S

FIG. 2 — PICKING CREWS, RUTLAND  
BENCHES. THE APPLES WERE A PYRAMID  
SCHEME WITH ROOTS.



Sec.02 // photo essay · Bernard Ave, 6am

## VACANCY

Six storefronts, one morning,  
zero people. A walking tour of  
what the “best downtown in

Canada” looks like before the  
patios open – and after the  
leases triple.

PHOTO — PAPERED-OVER STOREFRONT WINDOW

FIG. 3 — “FOR LEASE / GREAT EXPOSURE.” THE EXPOSURE IS DOING A LOT OF WORK.

Sec.19 // submissions · #2 — “the thaw”

## GET CRUMBS ON IT.

Serialized fiction, an open  
centrefold, a young-voices  
desk, a directory that stays  
current: #1 is a first draft of  
a scene arguing it exists. #2  
is “The Thaw” — what comes  
back. Send us your fury and  
your recipes.

HELLO@DAILYBREAD.EXAMPLE

DEADLINE · SEPT 15

*send poems. weird welcome.*

### WHAT WE TAKE

► **Art for the centrefold** —  
A4 landscape, 300dpi, any  
medium. We pay; rights stay  
yours.

► **Opinion (under 25)** — 500  
words of correct anger.

► **Poems & fiction** — we read  
everything twice.

► **Comics** — pitch us six  
panels for the guest slot.

► **Listings & corrections** —  
free, always.

### VOTE — #2 THEME

☐ The Thaw (what comes  
back)

☐ Water Rights & Wrongs

☐ Night Shift (who runs 2AM  
Kelowna)

MARK ONE · PHOTOGRAPH · SEND.  
DEMOCRACY.



Sec.19

// correspondence · write to us

## Crumbs Mail

READER CORRESPONDENCE · 100 EDITION

This box is empty because you haven't written yet. First issue problems. Fill it with fury, recipes, corrections, crushes (anonymized), and photos of the colouring page done wrong on purpose.

TIP JAR + SUBMISSIONS

SCAN, OR WRITE TO THE ADDRESS ON THE  
SUBMIT PAGE

PHOTO — EMPTY INTERIOR, CORDS ON FLOOR

PHOTO — SUN-BLEACHED MANNEQUIN

FIGS. 4-5 — SHOT ON EXPIRED FILM, APPROPRIATELY.

PHOTO — FOURTH FRAME

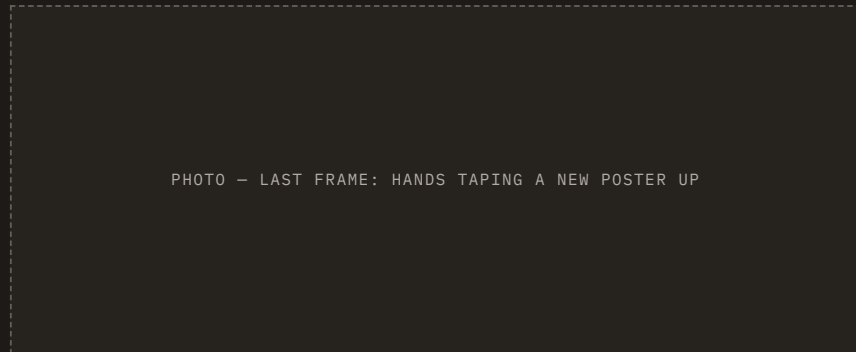


PHOTO — LAST FRAME: HANDS TAPING A NEW POSTER UP

FIG. 6 — SOMEBODY ALWAYS TAPES SOMETHING UP. THAT'S THE WHOLE THESIS.

Vacancy isn't emptiness — it's  
a waiting room. Every papered  
window downtown is a bet

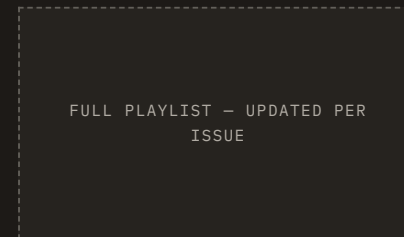
someone rich made against  
someone broke. The essay ends  
where the bets get called.

Sec.16

// listening · loud in the paste-up room

WHAT WE'RE LISTENING TO

## Rotation



FULL PLAYLIST — UPDATED PER  
ISSUE

SEND US ONE SONG + ONE SENTENCE

| STAFF ROTATION / #1                                              |                                 | LOUD |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|------|
| <b>"Bench Water"</b><br>— local EP                               | THE CONNECTOR,<br>AT NIGHT      |      |
| <b>ballroom sets —</b><br><b>Paris Is Burning</b><br>warm-ups    | PRE-<br>SCREENING<br>HOMEWORK   |      |
| <b>snotty coast punk —</b><br><b>7" from a Rutland</b><br>garage | PASTE-<br>UP<br>FUEL            |      |
| <b>a sylx</b><br><b>songwriter's</b><br>live tape                | ASK AT THE<br>RECORD STALL      |      |
| <b>disco edits for</b><br><b>the beach</b><br>assembly           | AUG 15,<br>BRING<br>SPEAKERS    |      |
| <b>the diner</b><br><b>jukebox, booth</b><br><b>six</b>          | FIELD<br>RECORDING,<br>HONESTLY |      |
| <b>whatever the</b><br><b>night cook hums</b>                    | UNRELEASED.<br>PROTECTED.       |      |

Sec.15 // food · no free meals, no mercy

# The Bite Back

RESTAURANT CRITIQUE · NO FREE MEALS, NO MERCY

WINE BAR ·  
LAKESHORE · \$\$\$\$

2/5 –  
GORGEOUS,  
HUNGRY

## THE PLACE THAT REPLACED THE DINER

The room is stunning, the playlist is a moodboard, and the “heritage tomato moment” is one tomato. Our server was the best actor in the valley: she said “great choice” about a \$19 plate of air with total conviction. We left elegant and starving, then bought gas-station taquitos. Verdict: it photographs like a meal.

## HOUSE RULES

we pay full price · we book under fake names · patios judged by dog traffic · anywhere that feeds evacuation crews gets a permanent star

DINER ·  
RUTLAND · \$

5/5 – PROTECT AT  
ALL COSTS

## THE 24-HOUR SURVIVOR ON HWY 33

Coffee refills arrive before you ask, the hashbrowns have structural integrity, and the night cook remembers your order and your pronouns. Every collapse in this issue is survivable from booth six. Bring cash, tip like rent is due, because theirs is too.

Sec.03 // young voices desk · unreviewed. unedited. correct.

# YOUNG VOICES

Three field reports from writers who can't vote yet but can already do the rent math. We paid them; we didn't touch a word.

REPORT 01

AGE 19 · HOUSING

## NOBODY MY AGE CAN AFFORD TO STAY

I work two jobs and split a two-bedroom with three people, and I'm the success story. My group chat is a slow-motion goodbye party: Vernon, Calgary, mom's basement in Surrey.

*"Every viewing is forty people deep and one of them is always crying."*

Sec.03 // young voices desk · unreviewed. unedited. correct.

REPORT 02

AGE 22 · COMING OUT

## OUT AT THE PACKINGHOUSE

I came out at a bush party in Glenmore and the worst thing that happened was a guy named Tyler said "cool" and asked if I could drive him home. Not paradise, not hell, just a small city learning faster than its city council.

*geography is the last closet*

Sec.13 // reviews · field-tested

REVIEWS / FIELD-TESTED

ENDURED · 3/5

DRAG NIGHT · POP-UP

RIPS

### "HARVEST MOON" AT THE COMMUNITY HALL

A gymnasium, a rented fog machine, and the best crowd this valley has produced. The floor is lava and the lava is love. Next one: see calendar.

BAKERY · DOWNTOWN

4/5

### THE NEW SOURDOUGH PLACE ON ELLIS

The loaf is honest, the queue is chatty, and the owner slips day-olds to anyone who compliments the playlist. Crumb declined to comment, citing family.

CIVIC · ONGOING

0/5

### COUNCIL PUBLIC-HEARING LIVESTREAM

Buffering as dramaturgy. Runtime: eternal. One star added for the councillor who said "housing is for people" out loud; four removed for the vote after.

WANT A REVIEW? WE COVER ANYTHING QUEER-ADJACENT AND OKANAGAN-MADE: SHOWS, MENUS, ZINES, HOT SAUCE, CITY COUNCIL MEETINGS (AS PERFORMANCE ART). THE ONLY CRITERION IS THAT WE CAN ATTEND, TASTE, OR ENDURE IT IN PERSON.

Sec.12 // advice · certified since Tuesday

# Use a Local Guy

CERTIFIED · SINCE TUESDAY

**My parents keep introducing me as their “roommate's friend.”  
The roommate is my wife. Escalate or let it ride?**

— TIRED IN LAKE COUNTRY

Send them a fridge magnet of your wedding photo every month. No note. Bureaucracy respects witnesses and parents respect fridges. By magnet six you'll be “the girls.” By ten, they're paying for brunch.

---

**Is it a red flag if a date says Kelowna has “no culture”?**

— DEFENSIVE DOWNTOWN

It's a beige flag. Hand them this magazine, the calendar page, and a pen. If they come to one thing on the calendar, marry them. If they critique the font, you've met the editor — run.

Sec.03 // young voices desk · unreviewed. unedited. correct.

REPORT 03

AGE 17 · FIRE SEASON

## I'VE EVACUATED TWICE AND I CAN'T VOTE YET

My childhood photos are sorted by smoke year. We packed the car in 2021 and again in 2023, and both times the adults on the radio called it unprecedented. It has precedent.

*"I am the precedent."*

# THE WAITLIST

Trying to find queer-competent healthcare in the Central Okanagan is a part-time job with no benefits. We phoned every clinic so you don't have to; everyone we reached described the same triangle of phone tag, referral limbo, and a highway.

14

MONTHS  
• AVG  
GENDER  
CLINIC  
WAIT

2

PROVIDERS  
TAKING  
NEW  
PATIENTS

400

KM TO THE  
NEAREST  
ALTERNATIVE

Two evacuations in five years says keep it packed, not planned. Know your route out, your meeting spot, and one person out of town who takes the check-in calls. The writer in Young Voices shouldn't know this list better than city council does.

## THE GO-BAG / FIRE SEASON CHECKLIST

- ☐ Water – 4L per person, rotate it
- ☐ Meds + a photographed prescription list
- ☐ Documents in a freezer bag (ID, insurance, lease – ha)
- ☐ Chargers, battery bank, cash in small bills
- ☐ N95s from the smoke drawer. You have a smoke drawer
- ☐ The pets. Count them twice. Then the neighbour's
- ☐ This magazine – morale is supplies

## KEEP THIS PAGE / DIRECTORY

VERIFIED QUARTERLY · TEAR OUT  
OK

**Crisis line** (24/7, trans-competent) placeholder – verify before print

---

**Informed-consent clinic list** updated quarterly · this page

---

**Youth drop-in (14-24) °** wed + sat · downtown

---

**Mutual aid pantry** rutland · no questions

---

**Legal aid – tenant defence** first mondays · library

---

**Elder queer social (55+) °** thursdays · lakeshore

---

**Sober hangs °** see calendar, marked °

A RESOURCE MISSING? WRONG NUMBER?  
TELL US – THIS PAGE IS THE WHOLE  
POINT.

WHAT ACTUALLY HELPS /  
CHECKLIST

## FIELD-TESTED

- ☐ The informed-consent clinic list – updated quarterly

---

- ☐ Pharmacists can renew more than you think – ask directly

---

- ☐ Telehealth counts. Bad wifi is still shorter than 400 km

---

- ☐ Bring a friend to appointments. Bureaucracy respects witnesses

*shout out Deb, seriously*

*“My GP is great. My GP is also in Vancouver, where I don't live.”*

*“The pharmacist figured it out before any doctor did. Shout out Deb.”*

*“I got my referral the same month my lease ended. Guess which one moved faster.”*

*“Honestly? The group chat is the healthcare system.”*

FOUR OF ELEVEN INTERVIEWS · ALL ANONYMIZED · METHODOLOGY: SEE DIRECTORY



Sec.05

// interview · forty years of nerve

*"We didn't have a bar,  
darling. We had basements,  
and we had nerve."*

MISS DEMEANOUR · PERFORMING IN THE OKANAGAN SINCE 1986

"The audience got younger and the rent got meaner. In '86 the danger was people; now the danger is landlords. Where did everyone go when the venues closed? Nowhere, sweetheart;

ARCHIVED · SHOEBOX FONDS

**MD, continued:** People ask if I'm bitter about the decades in basements. Bitter? Those basements had better sound systems than half the clubs I've played since. We recorded everything on cassette. Someone's nephew digitized it all last winter and I cried

that's the secret. We're all still here, we just meet in gymnasiums and orchards and each other's kitchens. A scene isn't an address."

for a week. That's your history project right there – a drag queen's shoebox. The city archive called ME. I said darling, you're forty years late and you're paying for the shelving. They did. Progress is slow, then it's sudden, then it sends an invoice.

Sec.17

// film · classics, outdoors

MOVIES IN THE PARK / HOSTED BY DAILY BREAD

## The Rewind

CRITERION-SHELF DEEP CUTS

Old films, screened like they matter – because a town with no rep cinema deserves one anyway. Each issue: three from the queer canon, then we show them outside. Program notes below; lawn chairs on the calendar.

**BRING** – A BLANKET · BUG SPRAY · SOMEONE YOU'RE NERVOUS AROUND · A THERMOS (WE SELL NONE OF THESE ON PURPOSE)

#1 PROGRAM / 35MM ENERGY,  
NOTES DIGITAL BUDGET

**Paris Is Burning (1990)** – The ballroom documentary that gave the culture its vocabulary. Watch it with people; the applause is part of the text.

**My Own Private Idaho (1991)** – River Phoenix falls asleep on every road in the Northwest. The campfire scene alone is worth the mosquitoes.

**The Watermelon Woman (1996)** – Cheryl Dunye invents an archive because nobody kept one for her. Relevant to a magazine doing the same thing.

East Kelowna benches – history  
underfoot

**Oct 03** **Cassette night: the  
Shoebox Fonds**

venue TBA – Miss  
Demeanour presiding

**Oct 17** **Issue №2 launch +  
colouring contest**

location in №2.  
obviously

**MOVIES IN THE PARK / HOSTED BY  
DAILY BREAD**

**SUMMER SLATE / RAIN MOVES US  
AT DUSK TO THE LAB**

**Aug 14** **Paris Is Burning  
(1990)**

City Park, at dusk

**Sep 04** **My Own Private  
Idaho (1991)**

Ben Lee Park, at dusk

**Sep 25** **The Watermelon  
Woman (1996)**

Rutland Centennial  
Park, at dusk

FREE / PWYC • CAPTIONS ON •  
PROJECTOR + POWER: RECLAIMED  
CELLS, PROJECT HEX

**VOTE – OCTOBER SCREENING**

☐ Portrait of a Lady on  
Fire (2019)

☐ Hedwig and the Angry Inch  
(2001)

☐ Bound (1996)

MARK ONE • PHOTOGRAPH • SEND.  
FILM DEMOCRACY.

**Sec.06** // poetry • submissions • lit

## Late Effect

the ogopogo is real and she is tired  
of being your tourism budget  
she surfaces only for girls  
who skip stones left-handed  
and boys who came out in a parking lot  
she keeps every ring ever thrown in.

– SUBMITTED FROM RUTLAND, AGE 20

## Harvest

my grandmother thinned apples so the rest grow large  
i learned it as economics  
she meant it as mercy  
this town keeps thinning people  
and calling the fruit a miracle.

– SUBMITTED FROM EAST KELOWNA, AGE 24

Sec.08 // crumbs · ep.1 · a golem seeks housing

## CRUMBS.

Our guest strip. Six panels, one loaf, zero vacancies. The slot is open, it pays, and the only brief is: make us laugh about the thing that isn't funny.

EP.1 · PENCILS, INK & CRUMBS BY OPEN CALL



TO BE CONTINUED IN #2 - "THE THAW." WANT THE GUEST SLOT? SIX PANELS TO HELLO@DAILYBREAD.EXAMPLE.

Sec.14 // the calendar · aug-oct 2026 · clip + fridge

## THE CALENDAR.

Listings are free; email by the 15th. Sober and all-ages options marked °.

| AUG - OCT 2026 |                                          | CLIP + FRIDGE                                |
|----------------|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Aug 07         | <b>First Friday at the Lab °</b>         | Riposte shop floor – tours, benches, zines   |
| Aug 14         | <b>Movies in the Park #1 °</b>           | City Park – Paris Is Burning                 |
| Aug 15         | <b>Queer Beach Assembly °</b>            | Gyro Beach, north end – bring shade to share |
| Aug 22         | <b>Harvest Moon drag night</b>           | community hall – PWYC at the door            |
| Sep 05         | <b>Zine-making + submission clinic °</b> | library makerspace – bring your fury         |
| Sep 15         | <b>#2 submission deadline</b>            | art, opinion, poems                          |
| Sep 19         | <b>Orchard walk with an elder °</b>      |                                              |

Sec.11 // fiction · serialized

SHORT FICTION

# THE LAKE TAKES

BY [AUTHOR] · ILLUSTRATION OPEN CALL

The realtor said the house had lake access, and it did, the way a mouth has throat access. June found the stairs behind the lilac on the second day – forty-one steps of split cedar going down to a dock that wasn't in the listing photos, because docks that old don't photograph, they testify.

Her grandmother had warned her about the lake in the language June only half-kept: it gives, but it keeps receipts. Every family on the bench had a story with the same shape – a ring, a brother, a hayfork, a name – something the water accepted and never gave back at the same size.

On the dock she found the offerings the winter had rearranged: a doll's shoe, a fishing licence from 1974, a phone in a sandwich bag, screen up, one notification still glowing like a lure. The lake was flat as a ledger. June, who had moved back for the cheap rent that no longer existed and the family that barely did, rolled her jeans and stepped down onto the first cold plank.

“Okay,” she told the water, the town, the whole arranged marriage of valley and debt. “Show me what you kept.”

CONTINUED IN #2 – “THE THAW”

Serialized fiction runs across issues. Miss one and the lake keeps your bookmark.

GUEST STRIP / ROTATING SLOT

FULL-PAGE GUEST COMIC — A DIFFERENT LOCAL CARTOONIST EVERY ISSUE. #1  
GUEST: [NAME], “PARALLEL PARKING AS QUEER PRAXIS”

Sec.11

// the wall · rip-out centrefold · pull gently

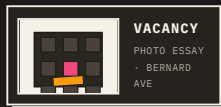
## THE WALL

The centrefold is a poster. Tear it out along the gutter and put it where a landlord can see it. This issue's wall belongs to the scene that refuses to be an address.

*yes — actually rip it*



ALSO ON THE WALLS /  
PLATE ROOM



COLOURING PAGE · PULL  
OUT

### COLOUR YOUR OWN COLLAPSE



The line-art page is yours. Crayon the orchard, redline the rent, sign the bottom. Photograph it and send it back; the best one runs the wall in #2.

Sec.08

// satire · crayon-proof paper

## COLOUR YOUR OWN COLLAPSE

#1

LINE-ART SATIRE CARTOON, COMMISSIONED PER ISSUE. #1: CITY COUNCIL, DRAWN AS CHEERFUL REALTORS, RIDE A SADDLED OGOPOGO ACROSS THE LAKE WHILE TOWING THE LAST QUEER VENUE ON A "LUXURY LOFTS" BARGE. PURE OUTLINES · NO FILLS · CRAYON-PROOF PAPER.

FIG. 8 — AISLIN-GRADE DISRESPECT, LOCAL EDITION

TEST YOUR CRAYONS:    

TAG US WITH YOUR FINISHED PAGE